Movie Review Platform
Course: CIS 344, Database Systems
GitHub Repository: Movie Review Platform

1. Project overview
I built this Movie Review Platform with PHP, MySQL, HTML, and CSS. The assignment called for a web app that talks to a database and takes input from an HTML form. That gave me a chance to use the relational database ideas and SQL operations from Fundamentals of Database Systems by Ramez Elmasri and Shamkant B. Navathe in an actual working project.

Users can do three things on it. They can post a movie review, read the reviews already posted, and look at stats on everything saved in the database.

2. Database connection and form integration
The data lives in a MySQL database called movie_review_platform. Inside it is a reviews table with six columns: review_id, reviewer_name, movie_title, rating, comments, and created_at.

On the homepage (index.php) there's a form asking for the reviewer's name, the movie title, a rating from 1 to 5, and the review itself. Hitting Submit Review sends it all to save_review.php through POST.

PHP checks the input first. If it's valid, a prepared INSERT statement writes the review into MySQL. The connection is set up in db.php using PHP Data Objects (PDO). Prepared statements help block SQL injection, and the database login details sit in their own config file instead of the main code.

To show reviews, the homepage runs SQL SELECT queries and lists what comes back. I opened phpMyAdmin to make sure the records were really landing in the database.

3. Unique features and functionality
The project goes past a basic form. A small statistics dashboard shows how many reviews have been posted and what the average rating is, and MySQL works those numbers out on the fly with the COUNT() and AVG() aggregate functions.

There are smaller touches too. The layout uses responsive CSS, each review gets its own card, and a success message appears after a submission. The header and footer are separate files (header.php and footer.php) so they can be reused. Anything a user types is escaped before it shows up on the page, which makes the site safer.

4. Setup instructions and documentation
Anyone who wants to run it locally needs XAMPP. The downloaded project folder goes inside C:\xampp\htdocs. With Apache and MySQL started, they import the included database.sql file through phpMyAdmin. Last, they copy config.example.php to config.php and fill in their own local database credentials.

From there, the site opens at http://localhost/movie-review-platform/index.php.

The GitHub repo has everything. That includes the full source code, the database setup script, a README with detailed instructions, and screenshots of the homepage and the saved records.

5. Conclusion

This project shows PHP and MySQL working together to take what a user submits, validate it, store it, and pull it back out later. Building it taught me a lot about connecting to a database, writing SQL, handling forms, and keeping a web app secure. It meets the assignment's goals for functionality, form integration, creativity, and documentation.